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Cyber SEA Game 2026 CTF

Practice Environment Guide

Practice Period: 19–23 October 2026
Competition: 26–27 October 2026

What is Cyber SEA Game CTF?

Competition Format

- All challenges follow a Jeopardy-style CTF format
- Earn points by solving challenges in multiple categories
- Submit flags through CTFd
- Different challenge sets on Day 1 and Day 2

Challenge categories

- Digital Forensics
- Malware Analysis
- Web Security
- Reverse Engineering
- OSINT
- Cryptography
- Miscellaneous

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Competition Environment

Competition Laptop (provided by the organizer)

- **OS:** Windows 11 Pro
- **CPU:** Intel® Core™ Ultra 5 235H (2.40 GHz)
- **Memory:** 32 GB RAM
- **Storage:** 1 TB SSD
- **Display:** FHD+ (1920 × 1200)
- **Architecture:** 64-bit

Internet Access

- Internet access via hotel Wi-Fi
- CTF infrastructure is IP-restricted
- CTFd and related services can only be accessed from approved networks

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Kali Linux Environment

Kali Linux (via Platform Experience)

- **Instance type:** t3.large
- **vCPU:** 2
- **Memory:** 8 GiB
- **Disk:** 40 GB
- GUI available
- SSH / RDP access (VPN required)

Windows laptop or Kali VM

Use either one, depending on the challenge requirements

About Windows Defender

Tools that Defender may detect (Hayabusa/Sigma rules, Metasploit, mimikatz, etc.) are installed on Kali, so they are not affected by Defender

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Software and Tools

Installed by the organizer

- Approved Tool List software
- Approved Tool Request submissions
- Latest version at the time installation starts (mid-October)

You may install

- Libraries
- Dependencies
- Plugins
- Packages

as long as the software is not related to Generative AI

Not allowed

- Standalone applications not on the approved list require organizer approval
- Software that requires a commercial license (e.g., IDA) cannot be used with a personal license

All teams use the same environment

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Allowed Resources

You may use the following during the competition

Google Search	Technical Documentation	CVE Databases	Vendor Documentation
Programming References	HackTricks	PayloadsAllTheThings	Microsoft Documentation
Linux Manual Pages	Google Translate		

Online services

Uploading challenge files to online services is not allowed (see FAQ at the end of this guide)

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Notes and Reference Materials

Both physical and electronic reference materials are allowed

Personal Notes	Cheat Sheets	Books
Printed References	Digital References	Personal Notion Pages
Personal GitHub Repositories	Scripts created before the competition	

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AI Policy

Generative AI is prohibited

You may NOT use

- ChatGPT / Gemini / Claude
- Claude Code / GitHub Copilot Chat
- Other AI assistants

You may NOT use AI to

- Generate solutions, code or scripts
- Analyze challenge content

NOTE: To ensure compliance with this AI policy, **participant screens will be monitored** by designated staff during the competition.

Exception: AI summaries automatically shown in search results (e.g., Google AI Overview) may be viewed

Competition Conduct

You must NOT

- Share challenge content externally
- Upload challenge content to AI services
- Request assistance from external parties
- Communicate through unofficial channels outside your team

You MAY

- Take notes
- Keep your notes after the competition
- Collaborate freely within your own team

Official communication channels will be distributed on the day of the competition

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Mobile Phone Policy

Deposit your phone

Mobile phones must be deposited at the designated collection area

During the competition

- No phones at competition tables
- No external communication devices

Monitoring

Organizers monitor participant activity throughout the competition

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Competition Schedule

Day 1 – 26 October

Time	Items
07:30–08:00	Registration
08:00–09:00	Demo & Technical Preparation
09:00–09:30	Opening Ceremony
09:30–09:50	Rules & Environment Briefing
10:00–17:00	Question Set 1 (incl. lunch & break)

Day 2 – 27 October

Time	Items
08:30–09:00	Registration
09:00–13:00	Question Set 2 (incl. lunch & break)
13:00–15:30	Write-up & Team Presentations
15:30–15:50	Satisfaction Survey
15:50–16:00	Break
16:00–17:00	Award Sessions & Closing Ceremony
17:00	Communication Party

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Explanation for Practice Environment

From here: how to use the Practice Session (19–23 October)

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Practice Environment

Practice Period: 19–23 October 2026

CTFd

Challenge portal for solving challenges and submitting flags

Platform Experience

Cloud-based practice environment (Kali Linux)

- Practice challenges are primarily based on previous competition questions
- Please use your own computer during the practice period

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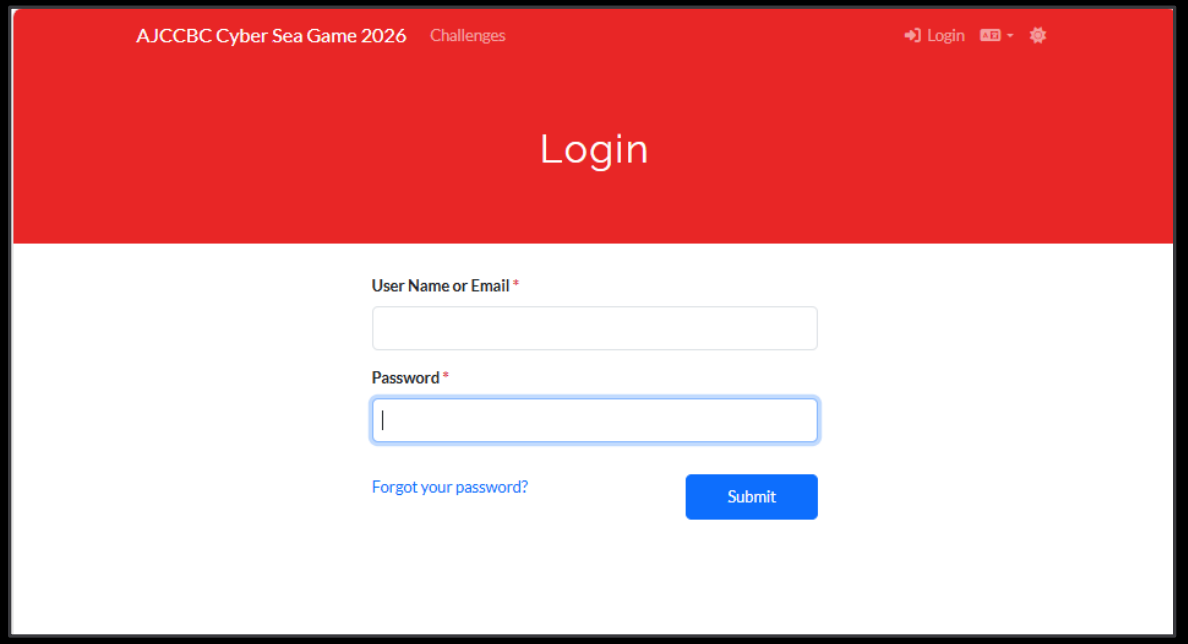
Access Information

CTFd URL

https://2026ctf.ajccbc-cyber-sea-game.net

Accounts

- Each country/team receives four accounts
- One account per participant
- Decide within your team who uses which account



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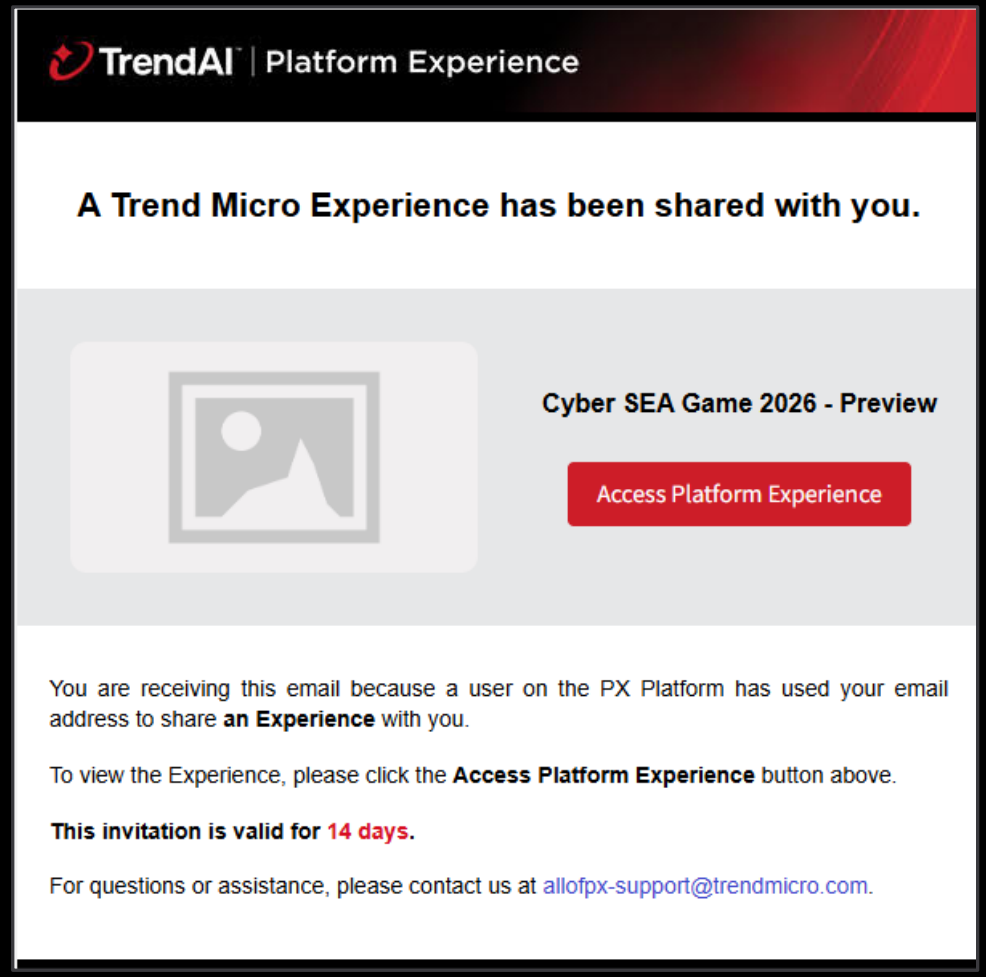
Gmail Access

CTFd ID = Gmail ID

Same username and password

Email domain: @trend.training

- Not a Gmail address, but uses Google's Gmail platform
- Log in from the normal Gmail login page
- The invitation is valid for 14 days

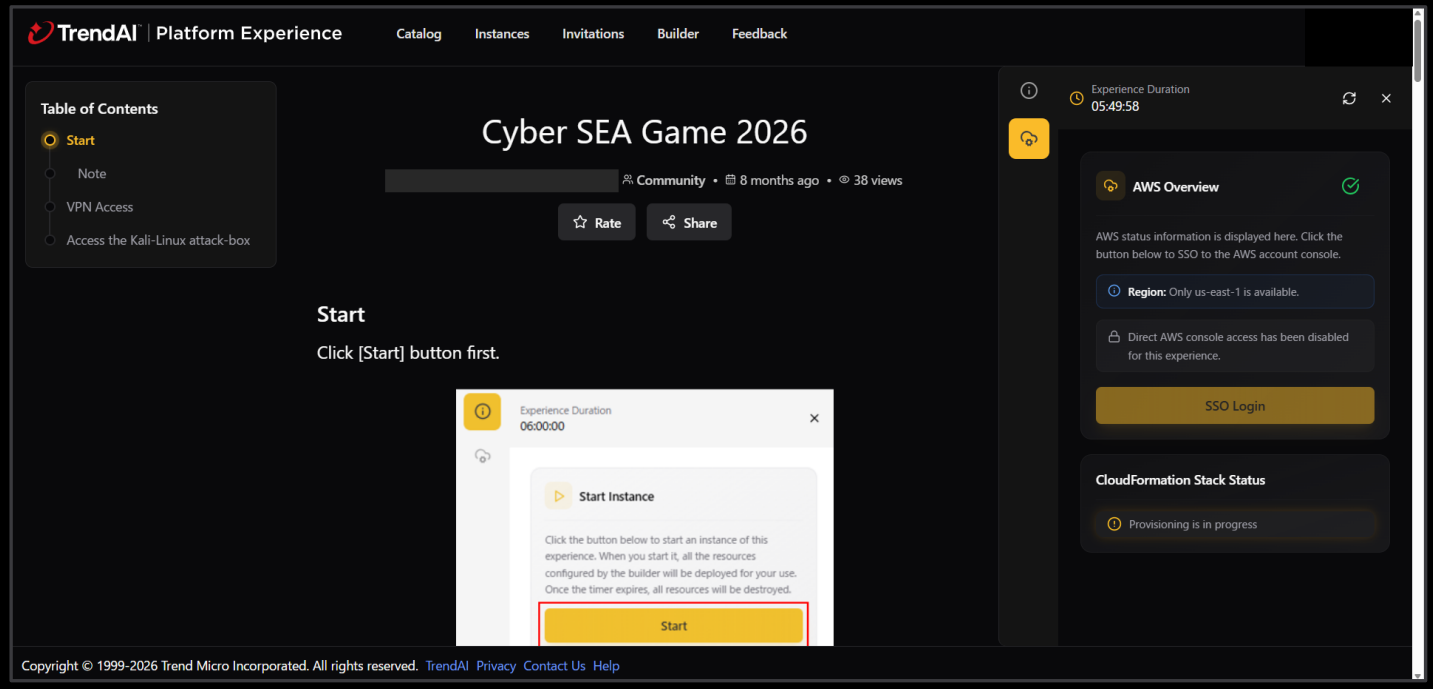


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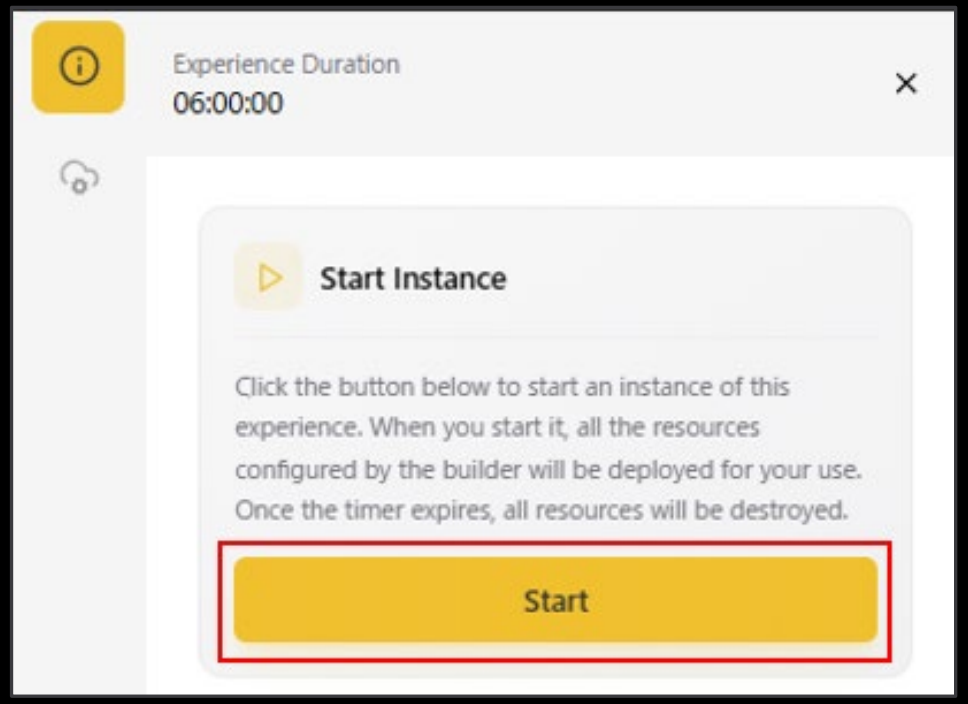
Platform Experience

After accessing Gmail

1. Find the Platform Experience invitation
2. Click “Access Platform Experience”
3. Complete onboarding
4. Reach the PX portal (Cyber SEA Game 2026)



Starting the Lab Environment



Steps

1. Click Start
2. Wait about 20 minutes
3. Do not touch the environment while it is deploying
4. Access the environment after deployment completes

Limit

Up to 3 launches per account

Warning

Terminate consumes the current session

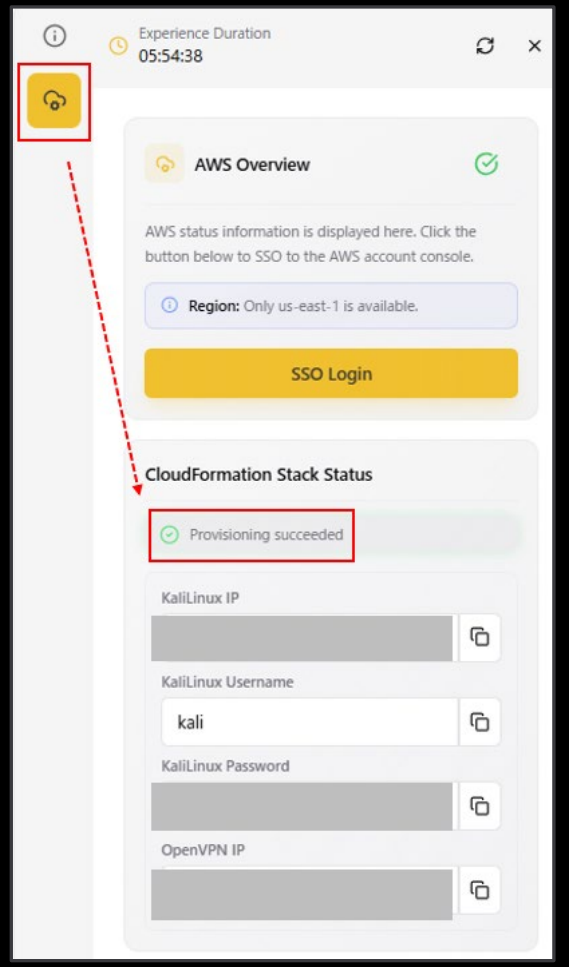
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Connecting to the Virtual Machines

Once deployment completes

1. Wait for “Provisioning succeeded”
2. Open the status panel (cloud icon) and check the Kali Linux IP, username, password and OpenVPN IP
3. Connect via VPN
4. Connect via SSH or RDP and start the exercises

Follow the guide shown in Platform Experience

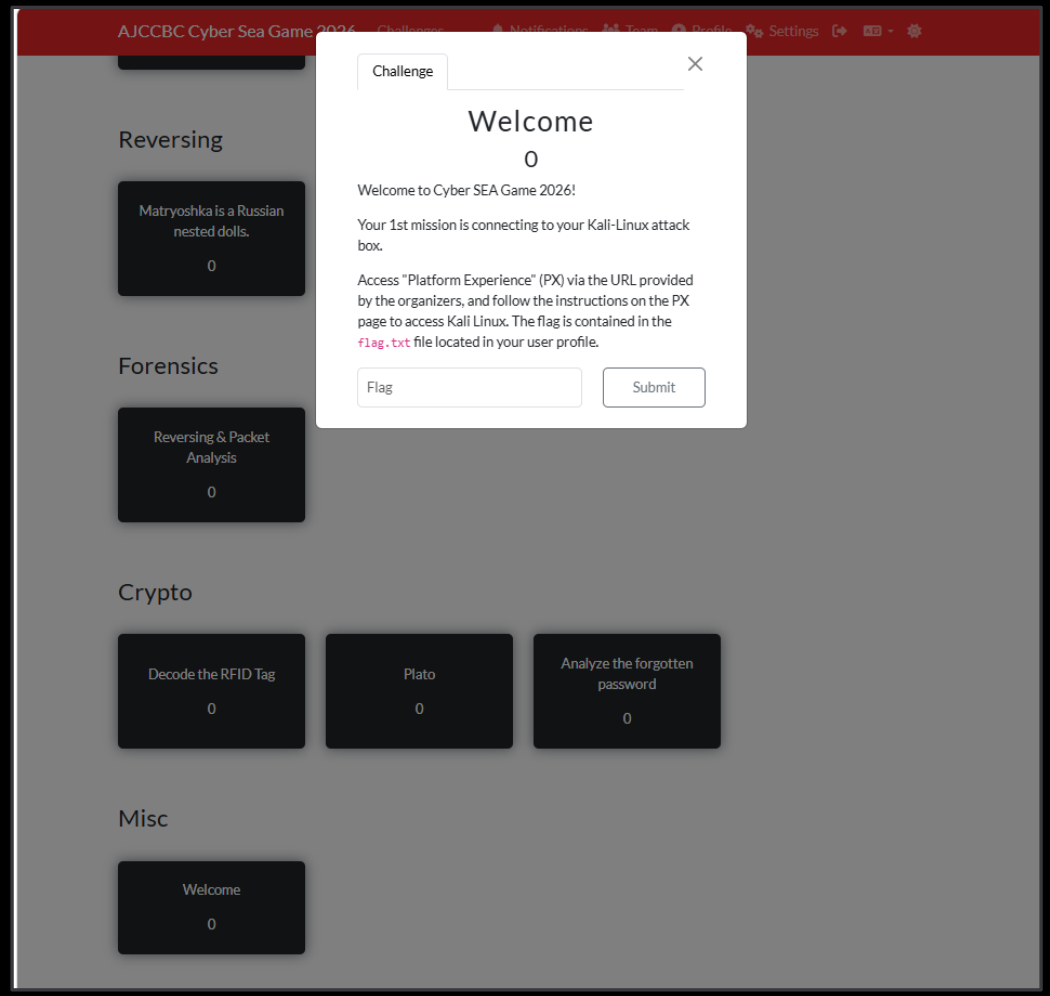


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Your First Challenge

Welcome challenge

1. Log in to CTFd
2. Scroll to the bottom of the challenge list and open Misc > Welcome
3. Follow the instructions and access Platform Experience
4. Connect to Kali Linux from Platform Experience and find flag.txt in your user profile



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Flag Format

CSG_FLAG{example_flag}

Flags typically follow this format

Submit the entire flag, including CSG_FLAG{ }, through CTFd

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FAQ ① Tools and Online Services

Q. Can I use online services such as VirusTotal, CrackStation, hashes.com, dCode, FotoForensics, Aperi'Solve, StegZero, online compilers or tool.lu?

A. Online services that require uploading challenge files are not allowed.

Q. Can I use my personal license for software that requires a commercial license, such as IDA?

A. Because the competition provides the same environment for every team, such tools cannot be used this time. Thank you for your understanding.

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FAQ ② Environment

Q. Windows Defender may detect tools such as Hayabusa/Sigma rules, Metasploit payloads or mimikatz. Can they be excluded?

A. Tools that Defender may detect are installed on Kali Linux, so Defender will not detect them.

Q. When are the tool versions decided?

A. Installation starts in mid-October, and the latest version at that time is installed.

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Have Fun!

Practice first. Learn the environment.

Verify your access before competition day. Good luck and enjoy Cyber SEA Game 2026!